XINYU WEI

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PROFILE

Applied microeconomist working on how households absorb income, health and care shocks and how social protection responds. Experienced with large household panels from China, Europe, the UK and the US, and with panel econometrics, impact evaluation and machine learning in Stata, R and Python. Previously wrote public macro-financial reports and taught applied econometrics; studied and worked in mainland China, Hong Kong, the United States and Belgium.

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITÉ LIBRE DE BRUXELLES, ECARES — Brussels, Belgium

PhD in Economics and Management — *Sep 2023 – expected 2027*

- Supervisor: Prof. Bram De Rock. Fields: household finance, labour economics, ageing and social protection.

Research Master in Economics and Statistics — *Sep 2021 – Sep 2023*

- Thesis: compared revealed-preference and latent-profile approaches to identifying consumer heterogeneity.

THE CHINESE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG — Hong Kong

MPhil in Economics — *Aug 2019 – Jul 2021*

- Thesis: monetary policy and the labour share in Chinese manufacturing (firm-level data, 1998–2007); expansionary shocks were associated with lower labour shares, with smaller responses among state-owned firms.

GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY — Washington, DC, USA

MA in Applied Economics — *Aug 2015 – Aug 2016*

XI'AN JIAOTONG UNIVERSITY — Xi'an, China

BSc in Economics — *Aug 2011 – Jul 2015*

- Presented "The Social Welfare Function and the Value of Life" at the JCER-RCHSS Economic Forum (2015).

RESEARCH

When Care Supply Becomes Care Demand: Functional Decline and Support Reallocation within Older Couples (working paper, 2026)

- Shows how caregivers' own functional decline reshapes support within older couples. Multiple functional limitations are associated with a 20-percentage-point higher probability of stopping partner care. Using SHARE, shows that outside help expands but also shifts towards caregivers' own needs, exposing care gaps hidden by household-level support measures.

Income Risk Exposure and Consumption Smoothing in China (working paper, 2026)

- Finds that lower-income households face greater income risk without a stable disadvantage in consumption smoothing. Across six CFPS waves, transitory income-shock variance is about 40% higher in the bottom than the top predetermined income tercile, while consumption pass-through shows no stable income gradient.
- Presented at the Mannheim Applied Seminar, March 2026, and the ECARES Internal Seminar, February 2026.

Time Poverty as a Constraint (work in progress)

- Shows that conventional time-poverty measures miss 67–78% of workers who work more hours than they want. Across Dutch, UK and US household panels, overemployment is associated with a life-satisfaction penalty equivalent to 13–21% of household income. These constraints are concentrated among higher-income workers, revealing time deprivation overlooked by standard time- and income-poverty measures.

Temporary Unemployment and Household Outcomes in Belgium (joint work under the HAIOPOLICY project; work in progress)

- Examines whether Belgium's COVID-19 temporary-unemployment benefits stabilised household income and supported employment recovery, using an event-study design on longitudinal EU-SILC/BE-SILC panels with a weighted comparison group.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ECARES, UNIVERSITÉ LIBRE DE BRUXELLES — Brussels, Belgium

Doctoral Researcher — *Sep 2023 – Present*

- **Conduct independent and collaborative empirical research** on household responses to income, employment, health and care shocks, covering research design, longitudinal data construction, econometric analysis, robustness testing and manuscript preparation.
- **Built the longitudinal EU-SILC/BE-SILC panels and analysis pipeline** for the HAIOPOLICY Belgian income-distribution project; produced measures of income mobility, volatility and persistent low income.
- **Identified a change in the sourcing of income variables** and established a consistent analysis window; proposed and drafted an event-study evaluation of Belgium's temporary-unemployment programme.

SHENZHEN FINANCE INSTITUTE, CUHK-SHENZHEN Shenzhen, China
Teaching and Research Assistant *Jul 2017 – Jul 2019*

- **Lead-authored several public Chinese-language reports** issued ahead of Federal Reserve rate decisions, explaining US macroeconomic developments and monetary policy to non-economist readers; maintained the underlying economic and financial datasets.
- **Compiled, cleaned and analysed Chinese local-government fiscal data** for institute research projects and conducted replication checks on faculty papers.
- **Coordinated programme operations:** delivered recruitment presentations, interviewed applicants, and managed visiting-faculty logistics and external programme review documentation.

HARVARD UNIVERSITY, CHINA GAZETTEER PROJECT Cambridge, MA, USA
Visiting Research Assistant *Sep 2016 – Jun 2017*

- **Coordinated daily data delivery for a five-person team** collecting and harmonising county-level data from Chinese gazetteers (Python, Stata); covered gaps to keep the team on schedule.
- **Ran data-quality checks** combining statistical screening of distributions with sample-based manual verification; contributed to analysis of education policies affecting ethnic minorities.

TEACHING

SHENZHEN FINANCE INSTITUTE, CUHK-SHENZHEN 2017 – 2019

- **Applied econometrics labs (Stata):** independently taught weekly lab sessions to ~80 students in two sections over two years, selected by the supervising professor.
- **Tutorials and courses:** led problem-solving tutorials for quantitative and macroeconomics courses; taught an introductory R course; prepared syllabi and solution sets.

THE CHINESE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG 2019 – 2021

- **Teaching Assistant, Macroeconomics:** led problem-solving tutorials and graded assignments for undergraduate macroeconomics courses over two years.

SKILLS

- **Software:** Stata, R (advanced); Python, MATLAB (intermediate); LaTeX, Excel.
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent).

HONOURS AND ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Honours:** Honourable Mention, Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling (2013); 1st Prize, Shaanxi Province Mathematical Contest in Modeling (2012).
- **Interests:** Guqin, the traditional Chinese seven-string zither.